

Customer Survey Analysis Report (2025)

Executive summary

The 2025 matched-consumer survey was completed by **84 respondents** who were paired with registered investment adviser (RIA) firms through Datalign's advisor-matching platform. Respondents answered Net Promoter Score (NPS) questions about Datalign, rated the online form, and assessed the financial advisory firms to which they were matched. Respondents could also leave free-form comments explaining their scores.

Key insights

- **Datalign's overall NPS is very low.** Only **26 of the 84** respondents rated Datalign at 9 or 10 (promoters) while **43 rated it 0-6 (detractors)** and **15 rated it 7-8 (passives)**. According to Qualtrics, detractors are those who give an NPS rating of 0-6, passives rate 7-8, and promoters rate 9-10. NPS is calculated by subtracting the percentage of detractors from the percentage of promoters. Datalign's resulting NPS is **-20**, which is well below the 0+ score often cited as "good" and indicates that almost half of surveyed customers are unhappy with the matching experience.
- **Survey respondents generally liked the web-form experience.** Ratings for the form's **number of questions, relevance and clarity averaged about 4 out of 5** or higher (3 = neither satisfied nor dissatisfied, 5 = very satisfied). This suggests that the onboarding process itself is not the primary pain point. The distribution of ratings shows that the majority of respondents selected "Satisfied" or "Very Satisfied." **This is mixing API partners + Our form**
- **Most people were never contacted by the matched firm.** Only about **65 %** of respondents reported that they actually connected with the advisory firm. The combination of very low Datalign NPS and high form satisfaction indicates that customers' dissatisfaction is driven by outcomes after they complete the form—specifically a lack of follow-up from advisory firms.
- **The matched RIA firms receive mixed feedback.** Across the **55 respondents** who completed the firm NPS question, the overall NPS for the advisory experience is **-10.9**. Only **17 promoters** were recorded against **23 detractors**. The average satisfaction rating for the advisory firms was **3.55 / 5**, meaning most people felt neutral or slightly positive about the firms.
- **Performance varies widely by firm.** A few firms—**Creative Planning**—received positive NPS scores (+25) with small sample sizes. The largest cohorts were **Edelman** and **Carson Group**, each with about 20 responses; both firms registered an NPS of 0, indicating an even split between promoters and detractors. Others such as **EP Wealth**, **Mercer Advisors** and **Pure Financial Advisors** recorded strongly negative NPS scores.
- **Open-ended comments reveal two dominant themes:**

Find a single source of truth dire the with partners and attempt to contact the lead.

- **Lack of follow-up:** many detractors reported that they were never contacted or are still waiting for a call. Words like “not contacted,” “waiting,” and “no response” were among the most frequent in the comments.
- **Fit and relevance:** the positive comments tended to praise the matching when it worked (“good fit,” “great match”) or compliment the adviser’s professionalism.

The evidence points to a need for Datalign and its partner firms to improve the hand-off and follow-up process. Customers are generally satisfied with the intake form, but the failure of many firms to contact prospects drives unhappiness and negative word-of-mouth.

Survey snapshot

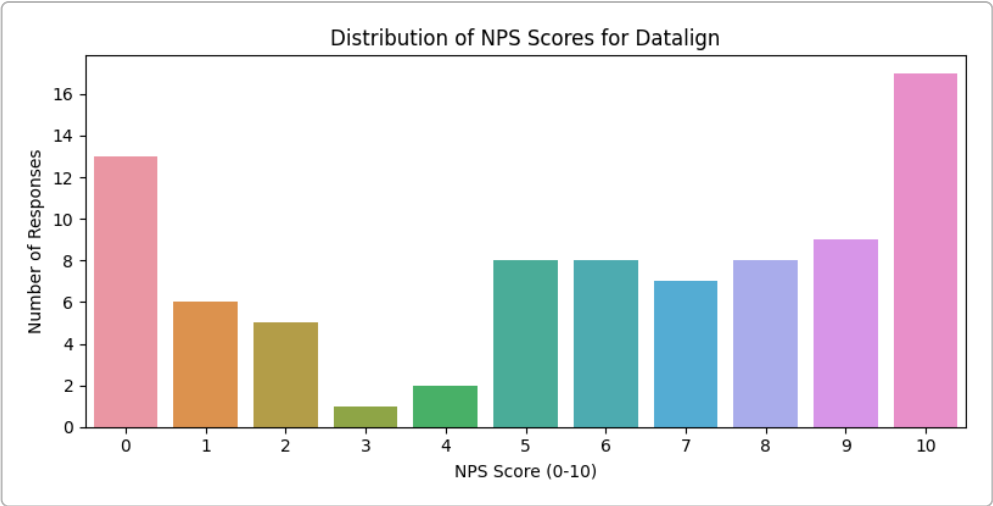
Metric	Value
Total responses	84 survey responses
Distinct RIA firms matched	16
RIA firms with ≥ 1 response	Edelman (26), Carson Group (22), Creative Planning (6), EP Wealth (6), Retirable (5), PCM Encore (4), Retirement Planners of America (3), Facet Wealth INC (2), Mercer Advisors (2), Pure Financial Advisors LLC (2), Exencial Wealth Advisors (1), Diversified (1), Evergreen (1), Highland Private (1), Stratos (1), Merit (1)
Datalign NPS responses	84 (all respondents)
Datalign NPS distribution	26 promoters, 15 passives, 43 detractors
Average rating of the web-form	Number of questions = 3.96/5, relevance = 4.01/5, clarity = 4.04/5
Connected with matched firm?	≈ 65 % said “Yes”
Advisory-firm NPS responses	55 total (promoters = 17, passives = 15, detractors = 23)
Mean satisfaction with firms	3.55 / 5

Detailed analysis

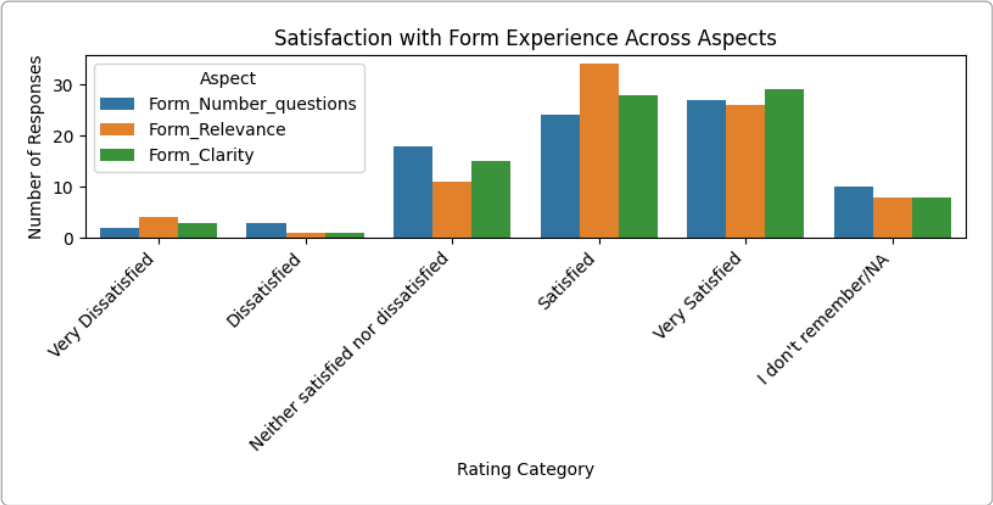
General analysis

The distribution of NPS ratings for Datalign shows a polarised customer base. As illustrated in the chart below, large clusters of respondents selected either the lowest rating (0) or the highest rating (10). This polarisation explains the negative NPS despite a sizeable contingent of promoters. Detractors frequently

complained about being force-fed a single firm, not receiving follow-up and feeling that advisors prioritised asset size over personal needs. Promoters praised the ease of the process, good matches and attentive advisors.



Respondents generally approved of the intake form. When asked about the number of questions, relevance and clarity of the form, the average rating across all aspects hovered around 4 out of 5. Only a handful of respondents expressed dissatisfaction. This indicates that the intake process is not the main source of frustration.



Connecting with the matched firm proves to be the pivotal moment in the customer journey. Roughly two-thirds of users reported successful contact. Those who connected were significantly more likely to recommend both Datalign and the advisory firm and rated their satisfaction higher. Among the one-third who did not connect, many said they were still waiting for a call or had decided to work with another advisor.

RIA-firm grouping analysis

The performance of individual RIA partners varies dramatically. The table below summarises the number of responses, average NPS rating (0-10), calculated NPS score and satisfaction for each firm.

Advisory firm	Responses	Avg NPS rating	NPS score	Avg satisfaction (1-5)	% Connected	% Not connected
Edelman	26	6.43	0.0	3.50	53.8 %	46.2 %
Carson Group	22	7.00	0.0	3.86	63.6 %	36.4 %
Creative Planning	6	8.25	25.0	4.50	66.7 %	33.3 %
EP Wealth	6	3.80	-60.0	3.40	83.3 %	16.7 %
Retirable	5	4.50	-25.0	3.75	80.0 %	20.0 %
PCM Encore	4	5.75	-25.0	3.25	100.0 %	0.0 %
Retirement Planners of America	3	—	—	—	0.0 %	100.0 %
Facet Wealth, INC.	2	5.00	0.0	3.00	100.0 %	0.0 %
Mercer Advisors	2	1.50	-100.0	2.00	100.0 %	0.0 %
Pure Financial Advisors, LLC	2	1.00	-100.0	2.00	50.0 %	50.0 %
Exencial Wealth Advisors	1	10.00	100.0	4.00	100.0 %	0.0 %
Diversified	1	2.00	-100.0	1.00	100.0 %	0.0 %
Evergreen	1	—	—	—	0.0 %	100.0 %
Highland Private	1	8.00	0.0	5.00	100.0 %	0.0 %
Stratos	1	9.00	100.0	4.00	100.0 %	0.0 %
Merit	1	7.00	0.0	3.00	100.0 %	0.0 %

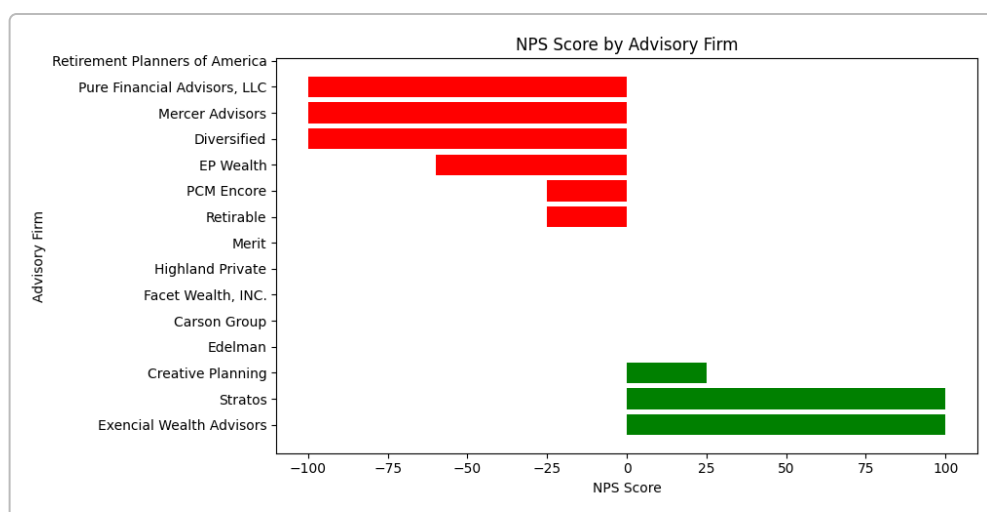
Observations

- **Creative Planning** is the standout performer with a positive NPS (+25), high average rating (8.25/10) and high satisfaction (4.5/5). Although the sample is small, comments describe knowledgeable advisors and a “good fit.”
- **Edelman** and **Carson Group**, the largest cohorts, both ended up with an NPS of 0—equal numbers of promoters and detractors. Their average satisfaction is middling (around 3.5–3.9). These firms need to improve follow-up and align expectations to convert passives and detractors into promoters.
- **EP Wealth** and **Mercer Advisors** exhibit particularly poor performance, with NPS scores of -60 and -100 respectively and low satisfaction scores. Respondents complained about unreturned calls and advisors seeming uninterested unless the prospect had substantial assets.



- **Retirement Planners of America** collected three responses but none of them included an NPS rating. All three respondents reported that they never connected with the firm.
- **Single-response outliers** like Stratos and Exencial Wealth show perfect or high NPS scores but the sample size is too small to generalise.

The variability across firms suggests that Datalign's matching algorithm works well in some cases but fails in others. Firms with high negative NPS should be re-evaluated as partners, while top performers should be highlighted.



Quantitative section

- **NPS metrics.** Detractors outnumber promoters for Datalign (-20) and, to a lesser extent, for the advisory firms (-10.9). Promoters tended to be those who connected promptly with an advisor and felt the match was a good fit. Detractors often reported being matched with only one firm, lack of follow-up or advisors who were “arrogant” or dismissive of smaller portfolios.
- **Satisfaction distributions.** Most respondents were satisfied with the intake form—27 selected “Very Satisfied” and 24 selected “Satisfied” for the number of questions; similar distributions were seen for relevance and clarity. Only a handful (<7 %) rated any aspect as “Very Dissatisfied.” Satisfaction with firms was more varied: 18 % rated their firm very satisfied, 22 % satisfied, 31 % neutral, 15 % dissatisfied and 14 % very dissatisfied.
- **Connection and NPS correlation.** Respondents who connected with their matched advisor were almost twice as likely to recommend the firm (average NPS rating 7.3 versus 4.2 for those who did not connect) and reported higher satisfaction. This underscores the importance of timely outreach from partners.

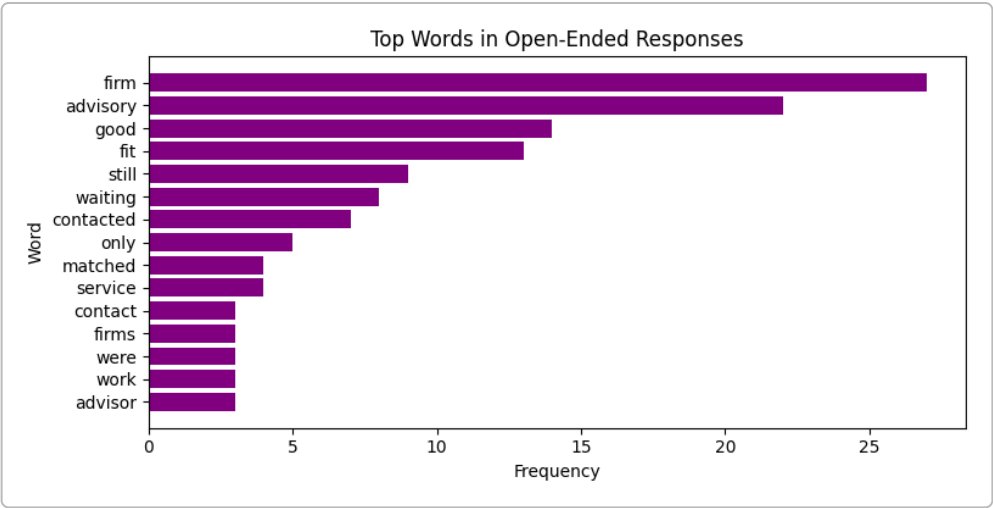
Qualitative section

Sentiment analysis. Using a simple lexicon-based approach on the open-ended responses, the average sentiment score was slightly positive (+0.02 on a -1 to +1 scale). This suggests that the written comments

were split between positive and negative sentiments. However, sentiment categories reveal clearer patterns:

- **Trust and caring advisors.** Positive comments often mentioned that the advisor “really cares” and expressed trust. These comments came from promoters who had connected and were satisfied with the match.
- **Useful resources and clear form.** Several respondents appreciated the educational content and the ease of completing the form.
- **Good match.** Some respondents were impressed with the matching service and felt their advisor was a “great match.”
- **Lack of follow-up.** Many customers stated that they were still waiting to be contacted or had not heard back after completing the form.
- **Limited options.** Detractors often felt that they were force-fed a single pre-selected firm and requested multiple options or better geographic matches.
- **Advisor attitude and asset focus.** A number of comments criticised advisors for being arrogant, dismissive or only interested in high-net-worth clients.
- **Mismatched communication.** Several respondents said their preferred contact method (e.g., email) or time was ignored, eroding trust.

The following bar chart highlights the most frequent words appearing in open-ended responses, excluding common stop words. The prominence of words like “**waiting**,” “**contacted**” and “**only**” underscores that follow-up and choice are primary pain points, while words like “**good**” and “**fit**” capture the positive experiences.



Representative quotes

Theme	Example quotes
Caring advisors	“Raul seems to really care. I trust him!” – a promoter who had connected and was satisfied.



Theme	Example quotes
Good match & service	"My preliminary impression is that it's a good match and I'm impressed with the matching service provided by Datalign Advisory."
Lack of follow-up	"I am still waiting to be contacted by the advisory firm." / "Never contact me again."
Limited options	"I would have liked to have received 3 different matches so that I could compare the firms."
Asset-focused advisors	"Seemed more concerned about how much money I had... If you are only looking to advise well-established, rich folks you should probably just say that."
Mismatch & poor communication	"Explicitly stated a preference for email contact and in the mornings. Immediately got a phone call in the afternoon." / "I thought I would be given information on several firms... I was force-fed one preselected."

Recommended actions

1. Ensure timely, preference-respecting outreach (highest priority). The most frequent complaint was that customers never heard back from the matched firm or were contacted at inconvenient times. Datalign should require partners to contact leads within a defined SLA (e.g., within 24–48 hours), adhere to the client's stated contact method and time, and provide proof of attempted outreach. Implement automated reminders and follow-up tracking to help partners meet expectations.

2. Offer multiple matched firms and enhance choice. Many detractors felt forced into a single match that was not a good fit or not geographically convenient. Providing at least two or three advisory options with profiles and reasons for the match would empower customers and increase the likelihood of a good fit. Including a map or distance indicator may address location concerns.

3. Re-evaluate and coach under-performing partners. Firms such as **EP Wealth**, **Mercer Advisors** and **Pure Financial** show consistently negative NPS and low satisfaction. Datalign should review partnership terms, share survey feedback and work with them to improve onboarding processes. If improvements are not forthcoming, consider limiting referrals to protect Datalign's reputation.

4. Highlight best-performing partners in marketing. Firms like **Creative Planning** and, on a smaller scale, **Stratos** and **Exencial Wealth**, received high NPS scores and satisfaction. Featuring their success stories can build trust and demonstrate the value of the matching service. Continue to monitor performance as sample sizes grow.

5. Refine the matching algorithm and data collection. Use qualitative feedback to expand the intake form to capture preferences such as desired fee model, minimum portfolio size, geographic radius and communication preferences. A more nuanced matching algorithm should reduce the incidence of poor fit.

6. Improve communication transparency. Set clearer expectations during the matching process. Inform clients that only participating firms will be presented and that compensation does not influence the match

Provide educational materials explaining why certain firms were chosen and how Datalign earns revenue, addressing perceptions that recommendations favour the highest bidder.

7. Follow up on non-connected leads. Build a mechanism to contact clients who report that they have not been contacted by their matched firm. Offering to rematch them or provide additional guidance can convert dissatisfied users into satisfied advocates.

8. Continue to monitor sentiment and feedback. Implement a continuous feedback loop with short post-interaction surveys. Track NPS and satisfaction scores by firm over time and maintain qualitative analysis of comments. Use this data to make evidence-based decisions about partner selection and process improvements.

By acting on these recommendations—particularly around follow-up, choice and partner quality—Datalign can convert detractors into promoters and strengthen the value proposition of its advisor-matching service.
